MODULE II

Performance Preparation

Prepare the cues, space, sequence, and recovery plan.



WALK THE ROUTE → SETTLE + SEE THE CUE

Walk-On and Settle

FINAL RELEASE
Finish together

→ QUIET PAGE CHANGE
Find the next page

→ STARTING NOTE
Listen quietly

→ NEW CUE
Wait for preparation

Between-Song Reset

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

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Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 101

Walk-On and Settle

Performance Preparation

7 minutes / Clear route and marked places.

Enter the performance space safely and become ready together.



WALK THE ROUTE → SETTLE + SEE THE CUE

Walk the route slowly first. Mark steps, cables, access and a clear view of the director.

1. Walk the planned route slowly, checking steps, cables, and access needs before singing.
2. Arrive at places, face the director, and allow a quiet moment to settle without a rigid pose.
3. Repeat the route and add only the opening preparation gesture, keeping the route unhurried.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Everyone reaches a usable place with a clear view before the cue.

COMMON TRAP

Adding singing before the route is safe and usable.

MAKE IT WORK

Rehearse seated arrival or an alternative accessible route individually.

ACTIVITY 102

First Ten Seconds

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Opening note and first phrase.

Make the beginning of a performance predictable.

READY → **EYE CONTACT** → **PREPARATION** → **FIRST SOUND**

READY	EYE CONTACT	PREPARATION	FIRST SOUND
Find support	See the hand	Ordinary breath	Enter together

Practise this beginning after different lengths of silence.

1. Practise the silent sequence: ready position, eye contact, preparation, and entrance.
2. Add the opening phrase once, then stop and reset rather than continuing the whole song.
3. Repeat with a longer audience-like pause so singers learn to wait for the cue.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group starts together even after an unfamiliar pause.

COMMON TRAP

Starting the phrase before everyone sees the cue.

MAKE IT WORK

Supply the starting note immediately before every attempt.

ACTIVITY 103

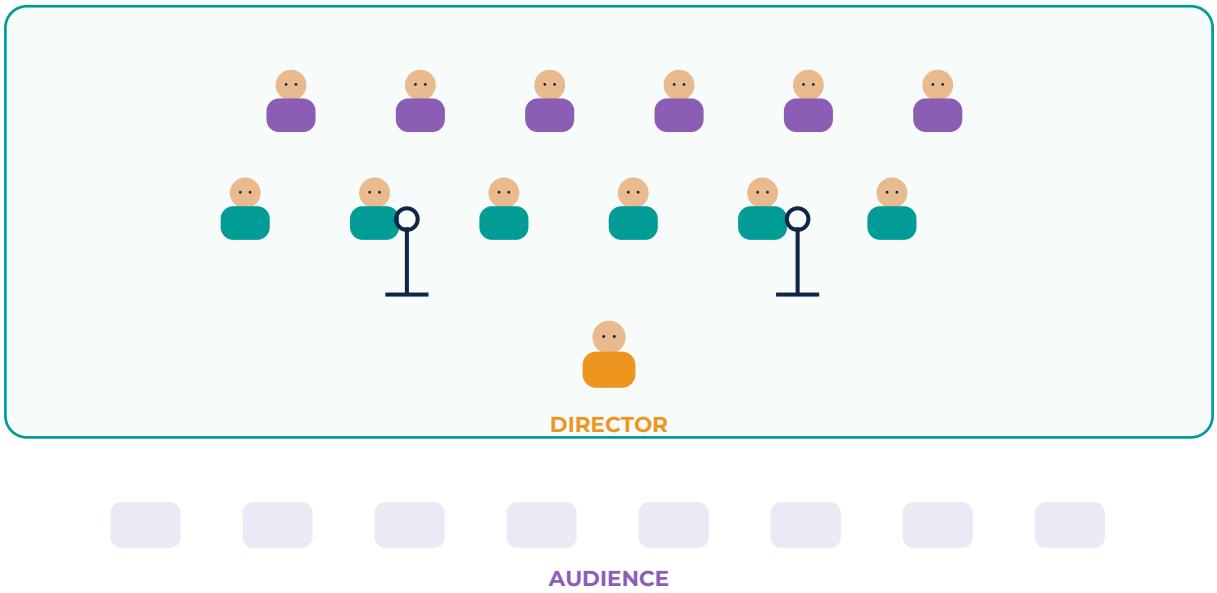
Microphone Distance Check

Performance Preparation

8 minutes / Performance microphone and sound operator, if available.

Find a practical amplified setup without singing louder to compensate.

Test normal singing with the sound operator



Test positions with the sound operator and a normal singing voice; no fixed distance suits every setup.

1. Ask the operator to set a safe working level while the choir sings a short representative phrase normally.
2. Try the planned positions without blocking faces or access routes; do not handle equipment without permission.
3. Repeat the phrase and agree which position gives clear sound without forcing; note the setup for the event.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The setup supports normal singing and clear visibility.

COMMON TRAP

Compensating for a microphone problem by singing harder.

MAKE IT WORK

If no microphone is available, map the intended positions and discuss the soundcheck plan.

ACTIVITY 104

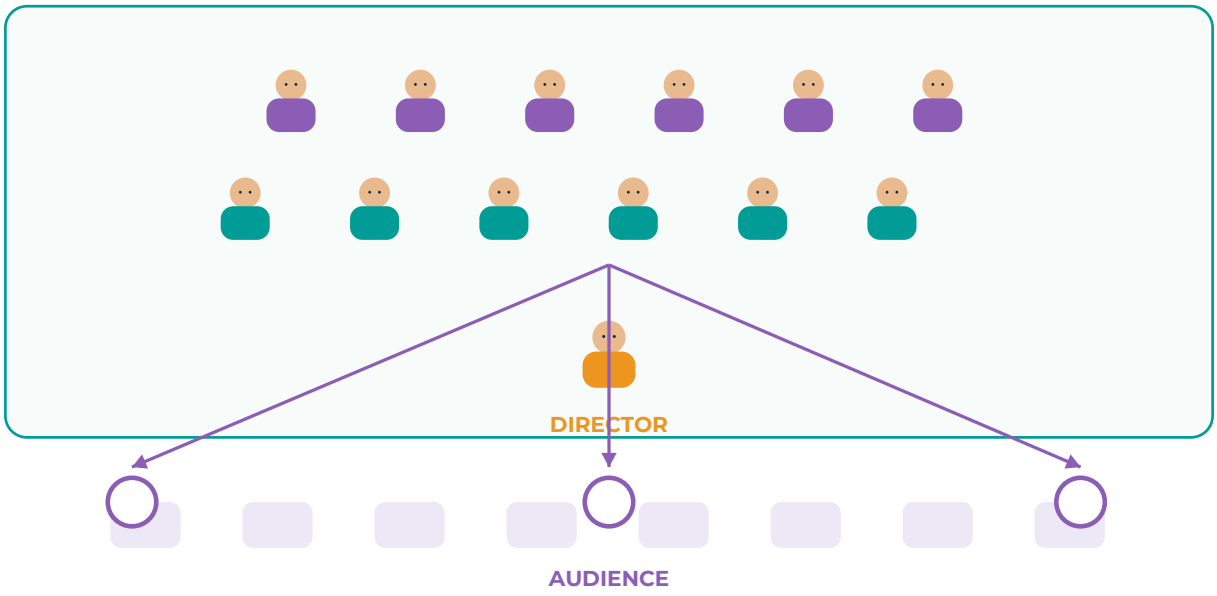
Audience Focus Points

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Three safe visual points in the room.

Look outward without losing contact with the director.

Return to the director for important cues



Plan brief outward moments, then return to the director for important cues.

1. Choose a centre point and two side points above audience eye level; keep the director visible.
2. Speak a line while allowing the eyes to reach the centre point, then return for the cue.
3. Sing the phrase, choosing planned outward moments rather than scanning continuously.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers communicate outward while still seeing important cues.

COMMON TRAP

Scanning the room continuously and losing the director.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep eyes on the director throughout if additional focus changes are distracting.

ACTIVITY 105

Between-Song Reset

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Two pieces and a clear order.

Handle the silence between pieces without confusion.

FINAL RELEASE
Finish together

→

QUIET PAGE CHANGE
Find the next page

→

STARTING NOTE
Listen quietly

→

NEW CUE
Wait for preparation

The next preparation waits until the group has found its place.

1. Rehearse the end of song one, including its release and the director's acknowledgement.
2. Change pages or positions during an agreed quiet interval; check that nobody is left behind.
3. Hear the next starting note and prepare only when the director gives the new cue.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The next piece begins without rustling through the preparation gesture.

COMMON TRAP

Turning pages through the preparation gesture.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a printed running order and larger page tabs.

ACTIVITY 106

Mistake Recovery Anchor

Performance Preparation

7 minutes / A familiar passage with clear bar numbers.

Continue after a slip using a planned musical landmark.

LANDMARK A → PLANNED SLIP → LANDMARK B



Listen and find B's word + note

After a planned slip: listen, find the director, then rejoin at the next agreed landmark.

1. *Choose two safe re-entry landmarks and confirm the starting words and notes for each.*
2. *The director briefly stops one group at a planned point while the others continue.*
3. *That group listens and rejoins at the next agreed landmark; discuss the route without blame.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

A slip does not force the ensemble to restart the piece.

COMMON TRAP

Scrambling to catch every lost note after a slip.

MAKE IT WORK

Practise with spoken text first and supply a clear visual cue at re-entry.

ACTIVITY 107

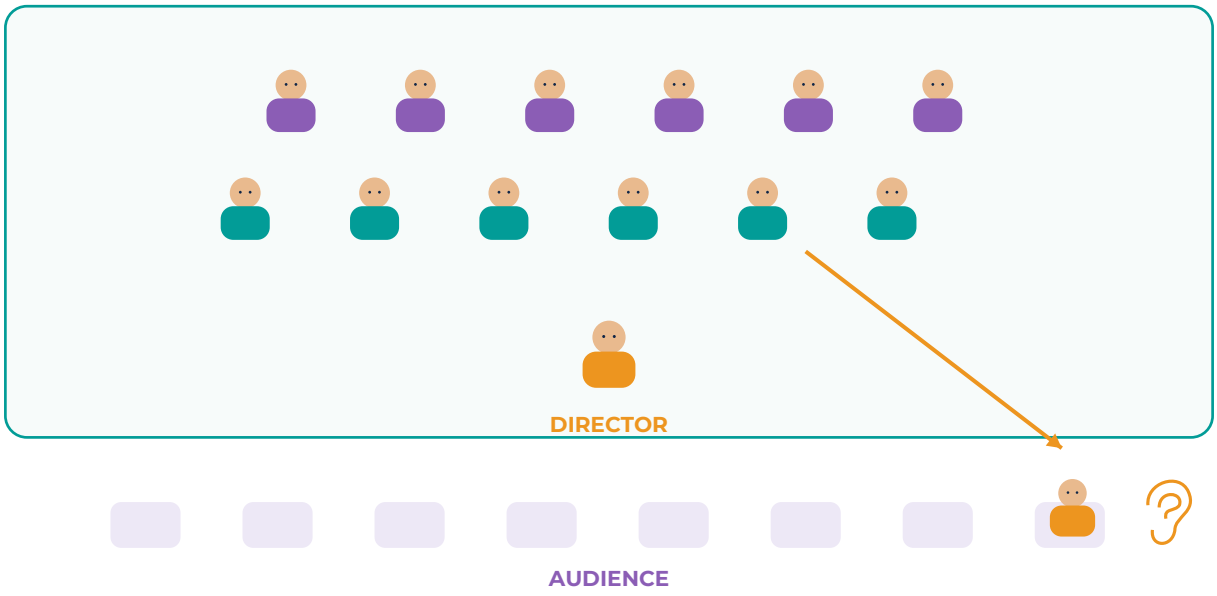
Acoustic Listening Pass

Performance Preparation

8 minutes / Performance space or a different rehearsal position.

Adapt balance to a room before changing vocal effort.

Hear the room from an audience position



A listener in the audience checks text and balance. Adjust the setup before asking for more effort.

1. *Sing a short passage at normal volume while a listener stands where the audience will sit.*
2. *Ask about text clarity, balance, and room resonance rather than whether it is 'loud enough'.*
3. *Change spacing, articulation, or tempo slightly and test again, keeping the voice comfortable.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

A practical room adjustment improves clarity without asking the choir to push.

COMMON TRAP

Asking only whether the room sounds loud enough.

MAKE IT WORK

Record only with permission; otherwise use one trusted listener.

ACTIVITY 108

Dress Rehearsal Checklist Run

Performance Preparation

8 minutes / Folders, music, attire or planned substitutes.

Test practical readiness using a short performance excerpt.

OPENING

Check visibility

PAGE TURN

Test score handling

ENDING

Keep the final cue

Test practical equipment, scores, clothing and access in a short real run.

1. Check footwear stability, score handling, lighting, and any needed mobility access.
2. Perform one opening, one page turn, and one ending exactly as planned.
3. Write down practical snags and assign someone to resolve each before the event.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Every discovered snag has an owner and a clear next action.

COMMON TRAP

Finding a snag without assigning someone to fix it.

MAKE IT WORK

Use substitute clothing or props if full attire is unavailable.

ACTIVITY 109

Final Consonant to Stillness

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Final phrase of a song.

Finish a piece with coordinated sound and a calm visible ending.

COORDINATED ENDING

vowel	vowel	vowel	consonant
1	2	3	4



release

two attentive silent beats

Final vowel / agreed consonant / release / two attentive silent beats.

1. Agree when the final vowel, consonant, and conductor release occur.
2. Sing the ending, then remain comfortably attentive for two silent beats without freezing the body.
3. Follow the director's acknowledgement before changing pages or speaking.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ending is unified and the ensemble does not break attention prematurely.

COMMON TRAP

Holding the breath during the two silent beats.

MAKE IT WORK

Practise only the last word and the two silent beats.

ACTIVITY 110

Performance Debrief That Helps

Performance Preparation

7 minutes / A recent performance or a rehearsal run.

Use a performance experience to choose one constructive improvement.

EVIDENCE

A clear first entrance

ONE CHALLENGE

A rushed page change

ONE ACTION

Rehearse that transition

Name the exact musical moment, choose a task, and schedule the next test.

1. Ask the choir to name one musical success supported by a concrete example.
2. Choose one challenge the group can influence, locating the exact moment rather than blaming a person.
3. Agree one rehearsal action and schedule where to test it next time.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The debrief ends with a specific, achievable rehearsal task.

COMMON TRAP

Blaming a person instead of choosing a useful action.

MAKE IT WORK

Collect written observations and discuss them as group themes.